DAY 26 | PRE-READ

AI That Works Towards a Goal

A light read before Day 26. About 15 minutes, no code required.

Prepared by **Ahmed** | linkedin.com/in/ahmed-al-imaad

Why read this?

Everyone is talking about AI agents. Tomorrow you learn what an agent really is, how to build one, and when a simpler approach is better.

1. Assistant or agent?

An assistant answers one question at a time. An **agent** is given a goal and works towards it on its own: it plans, uses tools, checks results and keeps going until done. Think of the difference between asking a colleague a question and asking them to "sort out the delayed shipment".

Agent part	Human equivalent
Model	The brain that decides
Instructions	The job description and rules
Tools	Phone, email, systems access
Memory	Notes on the task and what the customer prefers
Guardrails	Policies and approval limits

2. Checking your sources

A careful researcher does not use the first search result blindly. They check whether it actually answers the question, and search again differently if not. **Corrective RAG** gives AI the same habit: grade the retrieved documents, and fix the search when the evidence is weak.

3. Teams of agents

A newspaper has researchers, analysts and writers, with an editor coordinating. Some AI systems copy this: a **supervisor** agent sends work to specialist agents. It helps when the jobs are truly different, and adds cost and confusion when they are not.

> **Key idea:** start with the simplest thing that works. Use an agent only when the steps genuinely cannot be decided in advance.

4. About tomorrow's assessment

Tomorrow includes MCQs on Days 21 to 25 and a milestone check. Prepare a short demo of your RAG or agent prototype, with notes on what works and what does not yet.

5. Think about these before class

- Which tasks in your job have steps that change depending on what you find?
- What permissions would you give an AI agent in your team, and which would you never give?
- How do you check whether a search result really answers your question?

Jiritsu (自律): autonomy, acting on one's own